

See the Whole Field Before You Build.



One move today: **positional thinking**. Map how your problem already gets solved, so you can see where to be different, and what you most need to test.

WHY BOTHER

You're not the first to notice this problem.

Good news: the problem is real. Mapping the field tells you two things you can't guess from your seat.

DIRECTION

The 'different' you must be

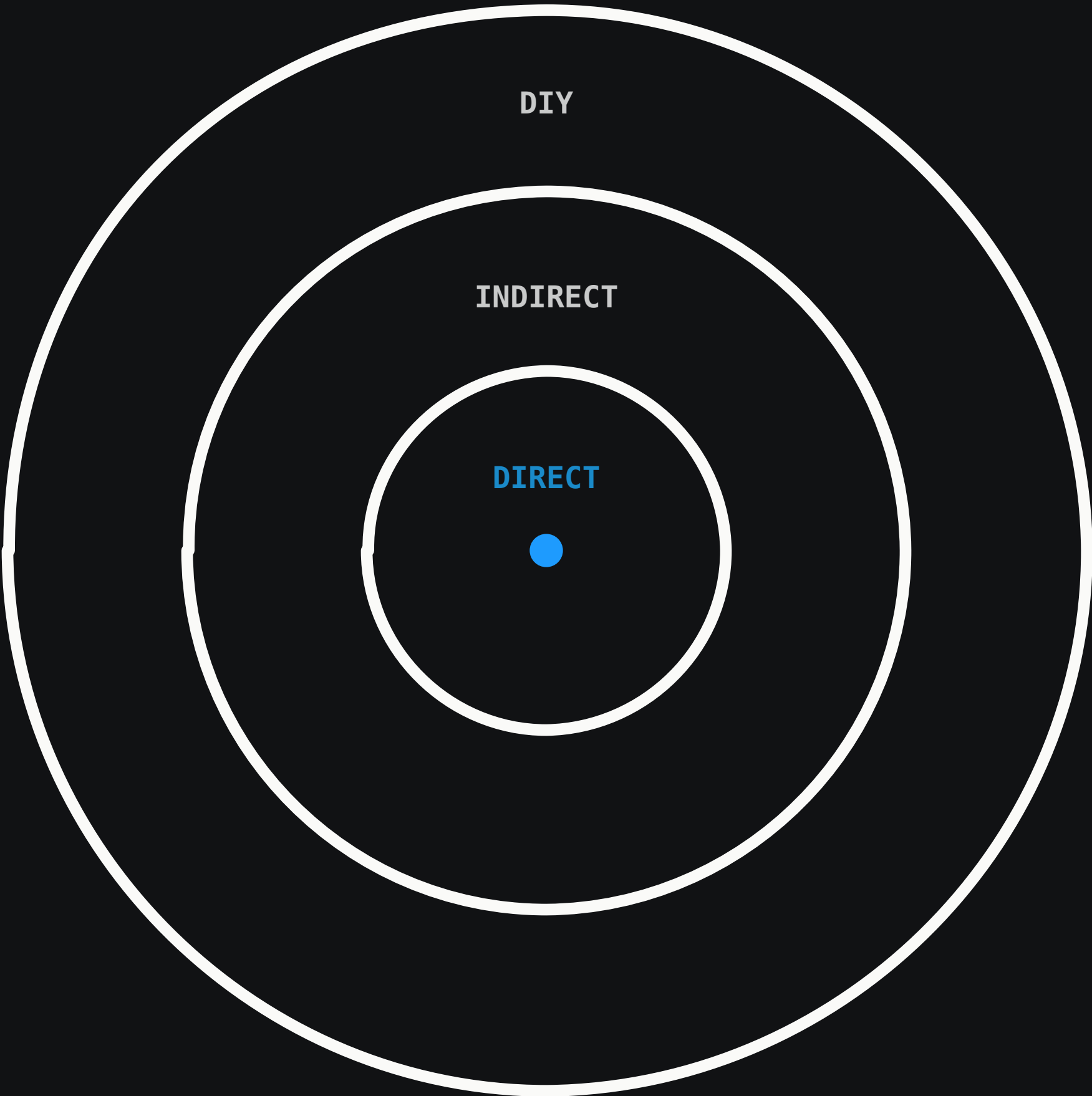
Where the field is crowded, and where it isn't.

DOUBT

What you're least sure of

The one assumption worth testing first.

How Does This Problem Get Solved Today?



READ OUTSIDE-IN

Three ways the same problem already gets solved, before you arrive.

Each ring is a real fix people use. Each one falls short for a reason.

WORKING EXAMPLE

"Teens Want To Stop Feeling Wrecked in the Morning."

MAP IT IN THREE LAYERS

01 DIRECT

02 INDIRECT

03 DIY

DIRECT COMPETITORS

01

Sleep-tracking apps.

Sleep Cycle, Calm.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

They still need you to choose to follow.

INDIRECT SUBSTITUTES

Melatonin. Curtains. Bedtime.

02

WHY NOT ENOUGH

None of them touch the 11pm phone scroll.

DIY WORKAROUNDS

03

Phone in the kitchen. Airplane mode.

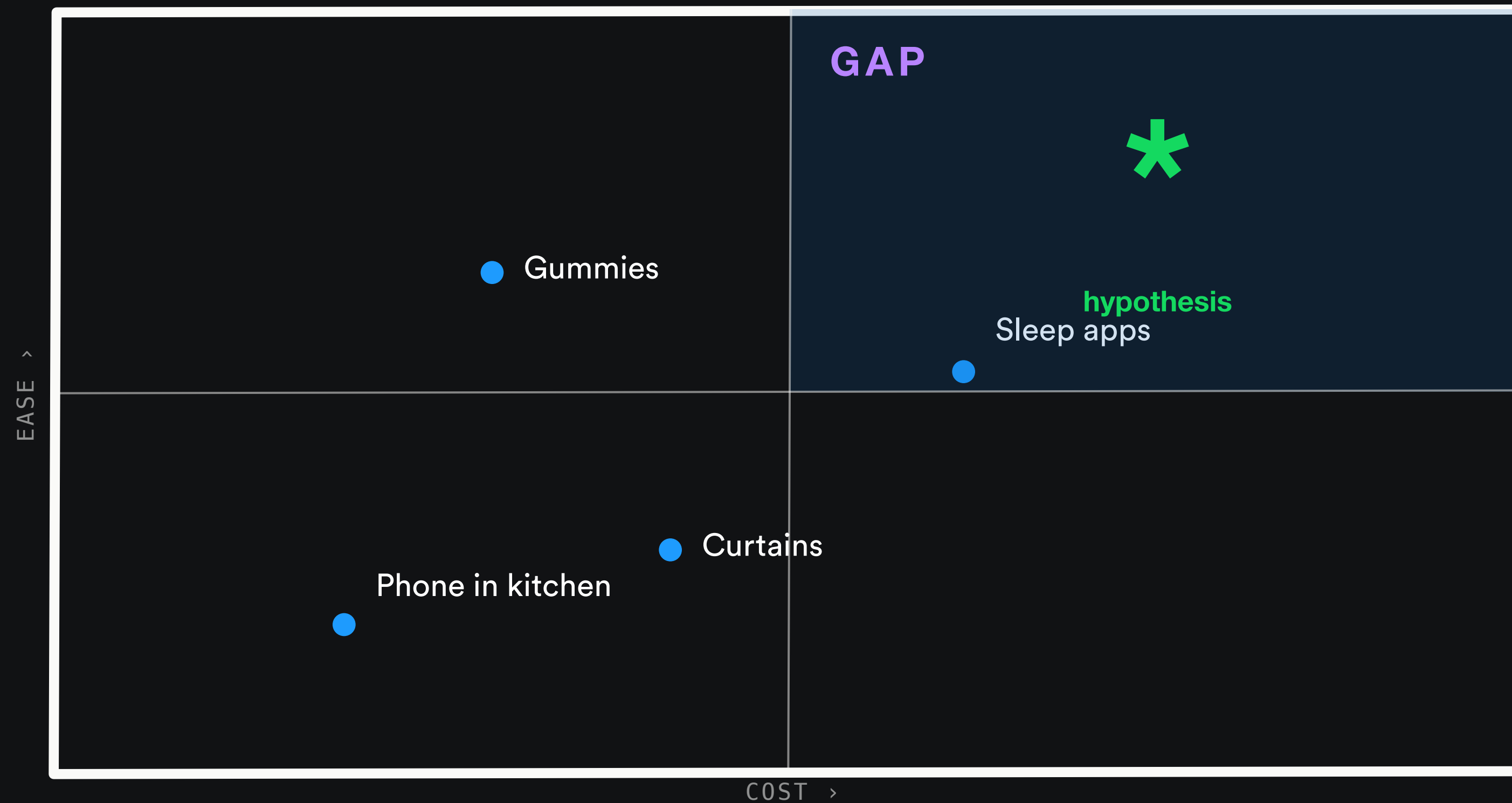
WHAT BREAKS

The moment willpower dips, so does the habit.

The Tell

**Each Layer Surfaces a
Different Truth About the Problem.**

PLOT THE FIELD, THEN READ THE EMPTY SPACE



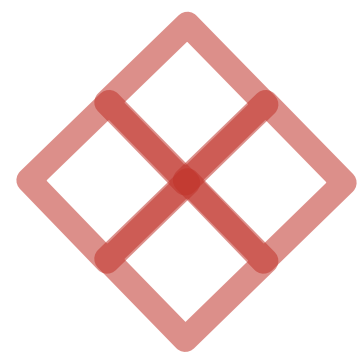
THE PAYOFF

It's not the dots. It's the empty corner, and the star you'd bet on.

WHAT THE AXES ARE REALLY FOR

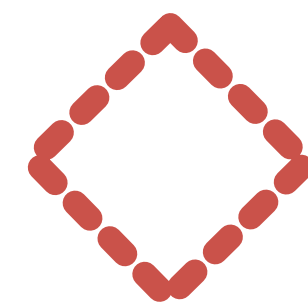
The Plot Isn't Decoration. It's How You See Position.

Default axes: cost by ease. Place each card relative to the others, then read the empty space.



TRAP 1: LAZY AXES

Cheap-vs-expensive teaches nothing. Capture what the customer weighs.



TRAP 2: EMPTY ISN'T GOLD

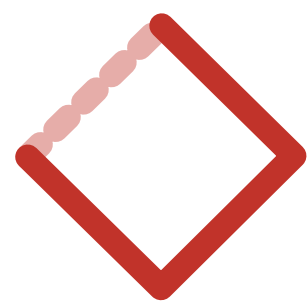
Blank can mean nobody wants it. A gap is a customer truth or opportunity.

FILL THE BLANKS, DON'T FREE-WRITE

Customer wants **outcome** but **the catch** keeps them out, so nothing today fills **the need**.

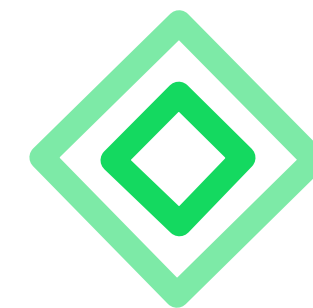
YOUR RISKIEST WORD

Your biggest unknown. That's what you carry to Out in Market.



FAILS

"No app like ours." About you, not the customer.



WORKS

Customer truth, the catch, what's missing.

ONE CANVAS, BUILT IN STAGES

Your turn.

We do Stage A's first card together, then your team runs each stage. We float, we don't fill it in.

STAGE A

Fill the field

8 named players



STAGE B

Plot the field

map and a star



STAGE C

Name it

gap and unknown



STAGE D

Translate

into the PRD



STAGE A / ~20 MIN

Fill the field.

Name who already solves this, across all three layers. The reason matters more than the name.

4

DIRECT

What they do, and where they fall short.

2

INDIRECT

Why people use them, and why not enough.

2

DIY

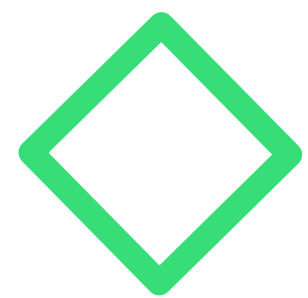
Why it works, and what breaks.

Checkpoint: 8 named players, each with its but.

STAGE B / ~15 MIN

Plot the field.

Move all 8 onto the 2×2, cost by ease. Place each one relative to the others.



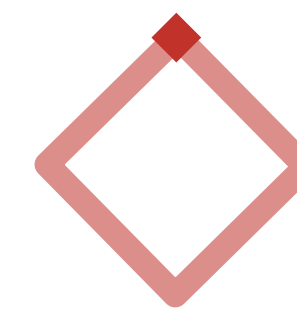
PLACE

Say why each one lands where it does, out loud.



READ

Where is it crowded? Where empty, and why?



STAR

Mark where you'd bet if forced.
As a gut feel, not a decision.

Checkpoint: a plotted map and one star.

STAGE C / ~10 MIN

Name it.

FILL IN YOUR GAP SENTENCE

Customer wants **outcome** but **the catch** keeps them out, so nothing today fills **the need**.

Then circle your biggest unknown, the riskiest word in that sentence.

Checkpoint: one gap sentence, one circled unknown.

BY 16:00, EVERY TEAM HAS

8

named players: direct, indirect,
DIY.

1

2×2 plot with your star hypothesis.

1+1

a gap sentence and a circled
unknown.

A GOOD MAP

DIY and substitutes, not just rivals. Every player has
a “but”. The gap is an opportunity.

A LAZY MAP

Only direct rivals. Names with no fall-short. Gap
reads 'no app like ours.'

TWO THINGS HAPPEN NEXT

Where your map goes next.

REALITY CHECK / TUE PM

Out in Market. Take your gap sentence to real people. Reality gets the deciding vote, not the whiteboard.

TRANSLATE / PAPER FIRST

Your filled canvas becomes the prompt: top 3, how it's solved today, and the gap, into your Lean Product Plan and your product/service.